



WAR
ON TERROR
THE AGENDA

Cover story

ISSUE

4

Mumbai exposed the inadequacies of our best anti-terror force. The shortfalls need to be addressed. Now.

MODERNISING THE NSG

The National Security Guard (NSG) was raised on the lines of Germany's GSG-9 in 1986 as India's elite anti-hijacking, anti-terror and bomb disposal force. Today, it is better known as a force that provides security cover to VIPs.

The Mumbai attacks has put the focus back on NSG's capabilities and revealed that the elite force is beset with the usual problems that India's uniformed personnel remain mired in for decades—archaic equipment and weaponry, procurements hauled up in the long waiting list with the nodal Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA).

The nation's top-notch terror fighting force 51 SAG, is manned entirely by army men, as is the 52 SAG, the anti-hijack squad. Equipment, manpower, training—you name it, and the NSG is lagging behind. The larger part of their equipment is aging and in state of disrepair. The sniper rifles that SAG uses, the Heckler and Koch PSG1, have not been replaced or upgraded since NSG's inception, basic equipment like collapsible ladders haven't been procured as yet. (see box)

"Who should be deciding